

# Code of Conduct & Business Ethics Policy

Narsimha Tech | Effective: 1 January 2025 | Internal Use Only

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## 1. Purpose & Scope

### 1.1 Purpose

This Code of Conduct & Business Ethics Policy ("the Code") sets out in detail the standards of ethical and professional behaviour expected of every Narsimha Tech employee, consultant, director, and contractor acting on the Company's behalf. It expands upon the summary Code of Conduct found in the Employee Handbook and provides operational guidance for common ethical dilemmas.

### 1.2 Scope

The Code applies globally, across all Narsimha Tech offices and remote delivery locations, and to all individuals engaged by the Company regardless of employment category. Where local law imposes stricter requirements than this Code, local law prevails; where this Code is stricter than local law or custom, this Code prevails.

### 1.3 Tone From the Top

Senior leaders are expected to model the behaviours described in this Code visibly and consistently, and are held to at least the same standard as, and in some respects a higher standard than, other employees, given their influence on organisational culture.

### 1.4 Annual Certification

All employees must complete annual Code of Conduct training via the LMS and certify electronically that they have read, understood, and will comply with the Code, as a condition of continued employment.

## **2. Integrity in Business Dealings**

### **2.1 Honesty and Transparency**

Employees must act honestly and transparently in all business dealings, including in communications with clients, vendors, regulators, and colleagues. Misrepresenting facts, capabilities, or pricing to a client or prospect — even where intended to "make the sale" — is a serious violation of this Code.

### **2.2 Accurate Records**

All business records — including timesheets, expense reports, project status reports, and financial records — must accurately reflect the underlying facts. Deliberately inflating billed hours, misrepresenting project status to a client, or falsifying any business record is treated as gross misconduct.

### **2.3 Fair Dealing with Clients**

Employees must not take unfair advantage of clients through manipulation, concealment, abuse of privileged information, or any other unfair practice. Where a project encounters a genuine delay, cost overrun, or quality issue, employees are expected to disclose this to the client promptly through appropriate channels rather than concealing it.

### **2.4 Fair Dealing with Competitors**

Employees must compete vigorously but fairly. This means no spreading of false or misleading information about competitors, no improper acquisition of a competitor's confidential information (for example, hiring a competitor's former employee specifically to extract their trade secrets), and no agreements with competitors to fix prices, divide markets, or boycott a supplier or client (which would violate competition/antitrust law).

### **2.5 Working with Government Entities**

Additional care is required when dealing with government clients or regulators, given heightened anti-corruption scrutiny. Any gift, hospitality, or favour offered to a government official, however modest, must be pre-cleared with Legal, and certain jurisdictions prohibit any gift to government officials regardless of value.

## **3. Anti-Bribery & Anti-Corruption**

### **3.1 Zero Tolerance**

Narsimha Tech has a zero-tolerance approach to bribery and corruption in all forms. Employees must never offer, promise, give, request, or accept anything of value in exchange for improper business advantage, whether the counterparty is a government official, client representative, vendor, or any other third party.

### **3.2 Facilitation Payments**

Facilitation payments (small payments made to expedite a routine government action, such as customs clearance) are prohibited, even in jurisdictions where they are locally tolerated, unless required to protect the immediate health or safety of an employee, in which case the payment must be reported to Legal within 24 hours.

### **3.3 Third-Party Risk**

Employees engaging agents, distributors, or other third parties on the Company's behalf must ensure appropriate anti-corruption due diligence is conducted before engagement, coordinated through Procurement and Legal, given that the Company can be held liable for corrupt acts committed by third parties acting on its behalf.

### **3.4 Political Contributions**

Narsimha Tech does not make political contributions on behalf of the Company. Employees may make personal political contributions or engage in personal political activity on their own time, using their own resources, provided they do not represent such activity as being on behalf of the Company.

### **3.5 Charitable Donations and Sponsorships**

Corporate charitable donations and event sponsorships must be approved through the Corporate Communications and Finance teams and recorded transparently, to ensure they are not used as a disguised channel for improper influence.

### **3.6 Red Flags**

Employees should treat the following as red flags warranting escalation to Legal: a third party requesting payment to an unusual account or in an unusual form (e.g., cash, cryptocurrency); a request for an unusually large commission with no clear business rationale; reluctance from a counterparty to sign standard anti-bribery contractual clauses; and any indication that a payment is intended to influence a specific official decision.

## 4. Conflicts of Interest

### 4.1 Definition

A conflict of interest exists when an employee's personal interests, relationships, or activities could improperly influence, or appear to influence, the objective performance of their duties on behalf of the Company.

### 4.2 Common Scenarios

- **Financial interest in a vendor or competitor:** An employee or close family member holds a significant ownership stake in a current or prospective Company vendor or competitor.
- **Hiring or managing relatives:** An employee is involved in hiring, supervising, or evaluating a close relative or someone with whom they have a close personal relationship.
- **Outside employment:** An employee undertakes outside work, consulting, or board membership that could compete for time, attention, or create access to competitively sensitive information.
- **Self-dealing:** An employee directs Company business to a vendor in which they or a relative have an undisclosed interest.
- **Use of confidential information for personal gain:** An employee uses non-public Company information (for example, knowledge of an unannounced acquisition) for personal financial benefit, such as trading in the securities of a relevant company.

### 4.3 Disclosure Obligation

Employees must disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest as soon as it arises, using the Conflict of Interest disclosure form on the intranet, and must update the disclosure if circumstances change.

### 4.4 Management of Disclosed Conflicts

Once disclosed, HR and, where appropriate, Legal will assess the conflict and determine an appropriate management approach, which may include recusal from specific decisions, reassignment of reporting lines, or, in limited cases, a determination that the conflict cannot be adequately managed and the relevant activity must cease.

### 4.5 Insider Trading

Employees who become aware of material non-public information about Narsimha Tech, a client, or a counterparty (for example, in the context of an M&A; advisory project) must not trade in the securities of the relevant company, nor "tip" others to trade, until the information has been made public.

## **5. Gifts, Entertainment & Hospitality**

### **5.1 Threshold**

Employees may not accept gifts exceeding INR 1,000 / USD 25 in value from any vendor, client, or business partner without prior written HR approval, consistent with the Employee Handbook.

### **5.2 What Counts as a Gift**

A "gift" includes physical items, event tickets, travel or accommodation provided free of charge, and any other item of value, but does not include ordinary, modest business meals taken in the course of a legitimate business meeting, which are treated under Section 5.3 below.

### **5.3 Business Meals**

Reasonable, occasional business meals with clients or vendors, consistent with normal business practice, do not require pre-approval but should be recorded as client entertainment in expense reporting where the employee is the host, consistent with the Global Travel Policy.

### **5.4 Gifts Given by the Company**

Employees giving gifts to clients or partners on behalf of the Company (for example, a festive season gift hamper) must ensure the gift is modest in value, consistent with Company branding guidelines, and recorded through the standard procurement process; gifts to government officials are not permitted without Legal pre-clearance, as noted in Section 2.5.

### **5.5 Gifts and Hospitality Register**

Any gift or hospitality received that approaches or exceeds the threshold in Section 5.1 must be logged in the Gifts & Hospitality Register, regardless of whether it is ultimately accepted, declined, or donated to a charitable cause as an alternative to personal retention.

### **5.6 Declining Gifts Gracefully**

Where an employee must decline a gift that exceeds the threshold, HR can provide guidance on doing so in a culturally sensitive and relationship-preserving manner, particularly important in client-facing roles operating across diverse business cultures.

## **6. Protection of Company and Client Assets**

### **6.1 Physical Assets**

Employees are expected to use Company equipment, office facilities, and physical assets responsibly and to report any damage, loss, or theft promptly to Facilities and, where relevant, IT.

### **6.2 Information Assets**

As detailed in the Terms of Employment (Section 8) and the IT & Information Security Policy, employees must protect Company and client confidential information from unauthorised disclosure, loss, or misuse, applying handling controls appropriate to the data's classification level.

### **6.3 Financial Assets**

Employees with access to Company funds, banking systems, or approval authority over payments must exercise this authority strictly within their delegated limits and must never use Company funds for personal benefit.

### **6.4 Intellectual Property of Third Parties**

Employees must respect the intellectual property rights of third parties, including not using unlicensed software, not incorporating copyrighted material into Company deliverables without appropriate rights, and following the Open Source Usage Policy referenced in the Terms of Employment when incorporating open-source components into client solutions.

## **7. Fair Competition & Antitrust**

### **7.1 General Principle**

Narsimha Tech competes on the merits of its products, services, and people, and does not engage in conduct that improperly restricts competition.

### **7.2 Prohibited Agreements**

Employees must never enter into any agreement, formal or informal, with a competitor to: fix or coordinate prices; divide markets or clients; restrict output or capacity; or boycott a particular supplier or client. Even informal discussions touching on these topics at industry events should be avoided and, if they occur inadvertently, should be reported to Legal.

### **7.3 Gathering Competitive Intelligence**

Competitive intelligence must be gathered only through legitimate means — for example, public filings, published pricing, and information voluntarily shared by a prospect — never through misrepresentation, deception, or improper acquisition of a competitor's confidential information.

### **7.4 Trade Association Participation**

Employees participating in industry or trade association activities on behalf of the Company should be mindful of antitrust risk in discussions with competitor representatives and should consult Legal in advance of any meeting where sensitive competitive topics might arise.

## **8. Data Privacy & Responsible AI**

### **8.1 Data Privacy Principles**

Employees handling personal data (of employees, candidates, or clients' customers) must do so in accordance with applicable data protection law and the Company's Data Privacy Policy, applying principles of data minimisation, purpose limitation, and appropriate security safeguards.

### **8.2 Client Data**

Client data accessed in the course of a project must be used solely for the purposes of that engagement and must not be retained, copied, or used for any other purpose, including for use on unrelated engagements, without explicit client authorisation.

### **8.3 Responsible AI Use**

Given Narsimha Tech's work in generative AI, employees building or deploying AI solutions — whether for clients or internally — must follow the Company's Responsible AI guidelines, which address bias testing, explainability, human oversight of automated decisions, and appropriate disclosure to end users where AI is materially involved in a decision affecting them.

### **8.4 Use of Generative AI Tools Internally**

Employees using generative AI tools (whether Company-approved or otherwise) for work tasks must not input Confidential or Restricted client or Company data into any tool that has not been specifically approved for that data classification by IT Security, consistent with the data handling principles in the Terms of Employment, Section 8.3.

### **8.5 Algorithmic Accountability**

Teams deploying machine learning models in client-facing systems must document model training data provenance, known limitations, and a process for addressing identified bias or errors post-deployment, reviewed periodically by the relevant Centre of Excellence.



## **9. Environmental & Social Responsibility**

### **9.1 Environmental Commitment**

Narsimha Tech is committed to minimising its environmental footprint, including through the responsible travel principles described in the Global Travel Policy, energy-efficient office design, and responsible e-waste disposal for retired IT equipment.

### **9.2 Community Engagement**

The Company supports employee volunteering (see Detailed Leave Policy, Section 10.6) and corporate giving programmes, coordinated through Corporate Communications, aligned with the Company's chosen focus areas (education and digital literacy, in particular).

### **9.3 Supply Chain Responsibility**

Procurement is expected to apply basic responsible sourcing diligence when engaging significant vendors, including confirmation that the vendor does not employ child labour or forced labour and maintains reasonable labour standards for its own workforce.

## **10. Reporting, Investigation & Enforcement**

### **10.1 Speak-Up Culture**

Narsimha Tech actively encourages a "speak-up" culture where employees feel safe raising concerns about potential violations of this Code without fear of retaliation.

### **10.2 Reporting Channels**

Concerns may be raised with a line manager, HR, Legal, or — for matters involving suspected fraud, corruption, or serious wrongdoing — through the Whistleblower Hotline described in the Employee Handbook, Section 9.4.

### **10.3 Investigation Standards**

All reports are reviewed and, where warranted, investigated by an appropriately independent function (HR, Legal, or Internal Audit, depending on the nature of the concern), following a documented process that includes a fair opportunity for any individual accused of wrongdoing to respond before a final determination is made.

### **10.4 Disciplinary Consequences**

Violations of this Code are addressed through the disciplinary process described in the Terms of Employment and may range from a verbal warning for a minor, first-time issue to immediate termination and, where appropriate, referral to law enforcement or regulators for serious violations such as fraud or bribery.

### **10.5 Cooperation with Investigations**

Employees are expected to cooperate fully and honestly with any internal investigation, including providing truthful information and not destroying, concealing, or altering relevant records; obstruction of an investigation is itself a serious Code violation.

### **10.6 No Retaliation**

The Company strictly prohibits retaliation against any employee who, in good faith, reports a suspected violation or participates in an investigation, consistent with the whistleblower protections described in the Employee Handbook.

## **11. Worked Scenarios**

### **11.1 Scenario: Vendor Gift at a Festival**

A long-standing vendor sends a Diwali gift hamper valued at approximately INR 3,000 to an employee's home address. The employee should log the gift in the Gifts & Hospitality Register and, since it exceeds the INR 1,000 threshold, seek HR approval; HR may advise either declining the gift, accepting it with disclosure, or donating it to a shared office welfare initiative, depending on the relationship context.

### **11.2 Scenario: Family Member Applying for a Role**

An employee's sibling applies for an open position on a team where the employee works, but not one they would directly manage. The employee should disclose the relationship to HR and recuse themselves from any role in the interview or hiring decision, even informally, to avoid a perceived conflict.

### **11.3 Scenario: Pressure to Inflate Billed Hours**

A project manager under deadline pressure asks a team member to log additional hours on a client timesheet that were not actually worked, to "smooth out" a previous under-billing. The team member should decline, as this constitutes falsification of business records (Section 2.2), and should raise the request with HR or via the Whistleblower Hotline if they are uncomfortable raising it directly with the project manager.

### **11.4 Scenario: Competitor Information From a New Hire**

A newly hired employee, previously employed by a direct competitor, offers to share the competitor's detailed pricing model with their new team to help win a deal. The team should decline this offer and report it to Legal, as using a competitor's confidential information obtained through a former employee's breach of their own confidentiality obligations exposes the Company to significant legal risk (Section 2.4 and Section 7.3).

## 12. Governance & Document Control

### 12.1 Policy Ownership

This Code is jointly owned by the Legal and Human Resources functions, with the Chief Compliance Officer (or equivalent designated role) responsible for overall stewardship and periodic review.

### 12.2 Related Policies

This Code should be read alongside the Terms of Employment, the Employee Handbook, the IT & Information Security Policy, the Global Travel Policy, the Data Privacy Policy, and the Responsible AI guidelines referenced in Section 8.

### 12.3 Document Control

| Attribute         | Detail                                                                                         |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Document Owner    | Legal & Human Resources (Chief Compliance Officer)                                             |
| Review Frequency  | Annual, or upon material regulatory change                                                     |
| Last Reviewed     | January 2025                                                                                   |
| Related Documents | Terms of Employment; Employee Handbook; IT & Information Security Policy; Global Travel Policy |

## 13. Records Retention & Document Management

### 13.1 Principle

Accurate and complete business records support sound decision-making, regulatory compliance, and the Company's ability to defend its position in any dispute or investigation. Employees must retain business records in accordance with the Company's Records Retention Schedule, available on the intranet.

### 13.2 Categories and Indicative Retention Periods

| Record Category                               | Indicative Retention Period                |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Client contracts and statements of work       | 7 years after contract end                 |
| Financial and accounting records              | 8 years (or longer if required by tax law) |
| Employee personnel files                      | 7 years after termination                  |
| Expense reports and supporting receipts       | 5 years                                    |
| Recruitment records (unsuccessful candidates) | 1 year                                     |
| Security incident reports                     | 5 years                                    |

### 13.3 Legal Hold

Where Legal issues a "legal hold" notice in connection with actual or anticipated litigation, regulatory inquiry, or investigation, normal retention/deletion schedules are suspended for the affected records, and employees must preserve all relevant material until the hold is lifted, regardless of any standard retention period that would otherwise apply.

### 13.4 Personal Devices and Records

Business records must not be the sole copy retained only on a personal device or personal account; the authoritative copy must reside on Company-approved systems, consistent with the IT & Information Security Policy.

## **14. Training & Certification Requirements**

### **14.1 New Joiner Training**

All new employees must complete Code of Conduct, Anti-Bribery, Data Privacy, and POSH awareness training within 30 days of joining, before being granted access to client-sensitive systems where applicable.

### **14.2 Annual Refresher Training**

All employees must complete annual refresher training on this Code via the LMS, with completion tracked by HR and reported to the Audit Committee as part of compliance reporting.

### **14.3 Role-Specific Training**

Employees in finance, procurement, and senior client-facing roles complete additional targeted training on anti-money laundering awareness and gift/hospitality handling, given their heightened exposure to the relevant risks described in Sections 3 and 5.

### **14.4 Non-Completion Consequences**

Failure to complete mandatory training by the communicated deadline may result in restricted system access until completion, and repeated non-completion may be escalated through the disciplinary process.

## 15. Escalation Matrix

### 15.1 Quick-Reference Escalation Table

| Concern Type                     | First Point of Contact                  | Escalation If Unresolved                  |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| General Code of Conduct question | Line manager or HR                      | HR Business Partner                       |
| Suspected bribery or corruption  | Legal                                   | Chief Compliance Officer                  |
| Conflict of interest disclosure  | HR (disclosure form)                    | HR Director                               |
| Suspected fraud                  | Whistleblower Hotline or Internal Audit | Audit Committee                           |
| Data privacy concern             | IT Security / Data Privacy Officer      | CISO                                      |
| Sexual harassment                | Internal Complaints Committee           | N/A (ICC decision is final within policy) |
| Antitrust/competition concern    | Legal                                   | General Counsel                           |

### 15.2 When in Doubt

Employees uncertain which channel applies to a specific concern should default to raising it with HR or Legal, who will route it to the appropriate function; no employee will be criticised for raising a genuine concern through the "wrong" channel in good faith.

## 16. Frequently Asked Questions

**Q: A vendor invited me to a sporting event with tickets worth around INR 4,000 — can I attend?**

A: This exceeds the INR 1,000 threshold in Section 5.1 and requires prior written HR approval; log the invitation in the Gifts & Hospitality Register and check with HR before accepting.

**Q: I noticed a colleague appears to be claiming travel expenses for trips that did not happen — what should I do?**

A: This is a serious concern that should be reported via the Whistleblower Hotline or to Internal Audit; you do not need to confront the colleague directly or gather proof yourself.

**Q: Does this Code apply to consultants and contractors, not just employees?**

A: Yes — Section 1.2 confirms the Code applies to all individuals engaged by the Company regardless of employment category, including consultants and contractors acting on the Company's behalf.

**Q: I'm not sure whether a particular gift exceeds the threshold once currency conversion is considered — what should I do?**

A: When in doubt, log the gift and ask HR for a determination rather than assuming it falls under the threshold; this protects you even if the value turns out to be borderline.

**Q: Can I keep frequent flyer miles earned on a client-funded trip booked outside the normal TMC process?**

A: Refer to the Global Travel Policy, Section 3.4 — personal retention of loyalty miles is permitted provided it does not increase cost to the Company and the underlying booking otherwise complies with policy.



## **17. Roles & Responsibilities Detail**

### **17.1 Chief Compliance Officer**

The Chief Compliance Officer (CCO) owns this Code, chairs the periodic Ethics & Compliance Committee review, and reports compliance metrics (training completion, whistleblower case volumes and themes, disciplinary outcomes related to Code violations) to the Audit Committee at least twice a year.

### **17.2 Legal Department**

Legal provides guidance on anti-bribery, antitrust, data privacy, and other regulatory matters referenced throughout this Code, reviews high-risk third-party engagements, and leads or oversees investigations into suspected legal or regulatory violations.

### **17.3 Human Resources**

HR administers the Conflict of Interest disclosure process, the Gifts & Hospitality Register, and Code of Conduct training completion tracking, and partners with Legal and Internal Audit on investigations with an employee-relations dimension.

### **17.4 Internal Audit**

Internal Audit independently investigates whistleblower reports involving suspected fraud or financial irregularity, and periodically tests compliance with key controls referenced in this Code (such as gift register completeness and training completion rates) as part of the annual audit plan.

### **17.5 People Managers**

People managers are expected to model ethical behaviour, respond appropriately and promptly to any concern raised by a team member, and never pressure a team member to act inconsistently with this Code (for example, the timesheet scenario in Section 11.3) regardless of business pressure.

### **17.6 All Employees**

Every employee is responsible for understanding and complying with this Code, completing required training on time, disclosing conflicts of interest promptly, and raising concerns through the appropriate channel described in Section 15.

## 18. Annual Compliance Calendar

### 18.1 Indicative Annual Cycle

| Period    | Activity                                                                                         |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| January   | Annual Code of Conduct certification campaign launched                                           |
| February  | Conflict of Interest disclosure refresh (all employees re-confirm or update disclosures)         |
| April     | Gifts & Hospitality Register reconciliation for the prior calendar year                          |
| June      | Anti-Money Laundering refresher training (finance, procurement, senior client-facing roles)      |
| September | Whistleblower channel awareness campaign                                                         |
| November  | Annual Code review by the Ethics & Compliance Committee; updates approved for the following year |

### 18.2 New Joiner Cycle

Independent of the annual calendar above, new joiners complete the training set out in Section 14.1 within their first 30 days, regardless of when in the year they join.

## 19. Glossary

- **Code of Conduct:** This document, setting out expected standards of ethical and professional behaviour.
- **Conflict of Interest:** A situation where personal interests could improperly influence professional judgement.
- **Facilitation Payment:** A small payment to expedite a routine government action, prohibited under Section 3.2.
- **Material Non-Public Information:** Information not yet disclosed publicly that a reasonable investor would consider important to an investment decision.
- **Whistleblower:** An individual who reports suspected wrongdoing through the channels described in Section 10.2, protected from retaliation under Section 10.6.

## 20. Annual Certification Statement

### 20.1 Sample Certification Language

Employees certify the following annually via the LMS: "I confirm that I have read and understood the Narsimha Tech Code of Conduct & Business Ethics Policy. I am not aware of any unreported violation of this Code, and I have disclosed any conflict of interest applicable to my role. I understand that failure to comply with this Code may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment."

### 20.2 Record of Certification

HR retains a record of each employee's annual certification as part of the personnel file, consistent with the retention schedule described in Section 13.2.

### 20.3 Document Control

| Attribute         | Detail                                                                                         |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Document Owner    | Legal & Human Resources (Chief Compliance Officer)                                             |
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| Last Reviewed     | January 2025                                                                                   |
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